

Word family: **quality / qualities / qualitative / qualitatively**

Base word: quality

Plural: qualities

Related forms: qualitative, qualitatively

Useful extensions: sound quality, quality of life, quality control, quality assurance, quality time, high-quality, poor-quality

Part of speech: noun (名詞) / adjective-like attributive use (定語用法)

Your sentence:

> “At the same time, the ad mentioned practical features like comfort, battery life, and sound **quality**, so it still felt believable.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **quality** means **how good the sound produced by the headphones is**.

It refers to the overall standard of the audio—for example, its clarity, detail, balance, richness, naturalness, and lack of distortion.

繁體中文: 耳機所產生的聲音在清晰度、細節、平衡、自然度和整體聽感方面所達到的品質水平

中文翻譯:

> “The ad mentioned practical features like comfort, battery life, and sound quality...”

「廣告亦提到了舒適度、電池續航力和**音質**等實際功能特點.....」

sound quality = 聲音整體表現的品質／音質

1. **quality of + product/service/work (產品／服務／工作) — 品質; 質素; 水準**

This is the central meaning and the one behind **sound quality**.

Meaning: The standard of how good or bad something is.

Practice 1 — Original

> “The ad mentioned practical features like comfort, battery life, and sound **quality**.”

「廣告提到了舒適度、電池續航力和**音質**等實際功能。」

Practice 2

> “The **quality** of the service has improved.”

「服務的**質素／水準**有所提升。」

Practice 3

> “Customers expect high **quality** at this price.”

「以這個價錢來說，顧客會期望有很高的**品質水準**。」

quality = 某項產品、服務或成果在「好與差」方面所達到的整體標準

2. **sound/image/video/build quality** (某方面的表現水準) —質素／品質

This is best treated as a **contextual branch of #1**, not a separate lexical meaning.

Practice 4

> “The camera produces excellent image **quality**.”

「這部相機能提供優秀的**影像質素／畫質**。」

Practice 5

> “The laptop has impressive build **quality**.”

「這部手提電腦的**造工品質／製作品質**很出色。」

Common combinations:

* **sound quality** = 音質

* **image quality** = 畫質／影像質素

* **video quality** = 影片畫質

* **build quality** = 造工品質

* **air quality** = 空氣質素

* **water quality** = 水質

The core idea is always:

某一方面達到甚麼程度的品質標準

3. **high-quality / poor-quality + noun (產品／材料／服務)** — 高品質的／品質差的

Quality commonly appears inside compound adjectives.

Practice 6

> “The headphones use **high-quality** materials.”

「這副耳機使用**高品質的材料**。」

Practice 7

> “Poor-quality audio can become tiring after a while.”

「**品質差的音訊**聽久了可能令人疲累。」

high-quality = 品質達到較高標準的

poor-quality = 品質低於理想標準的

Hyphen:

> **high-quality headphones** ✓

but:

> “The headphones are **high quality**.” ✓

4. **quality + noun (定語)** = of a high standard — 優質的; 高水準的

In some contexts, **quality** itself is used before a noun to mean **high-quality**.

Practice 8

> “The shop specializes in **quality** furniture.”

「這間店專門出售**優質家具**。」

Practice 9

> “Customers are willing to pay more for **quality** products.”

「顧客願意為**品質優良的產品**支付更高價格。」

quality + noun = 品質優良、達到較高標準的

Important:

> “product quality”

= 產品的品質

but:

> “a quality product”

= **一件優質產品**

The word order changes the meaning.

5. **quality = characteristic/attribute (人物／事物具有的特質) — 特質; 性質; 特點**

This is a genuinely different major meaning.

Meaning: A particular characteristic or attribute that someone or something has.

Practice 10

> “Patience is an important **quality** in a teacher.”

「耐性是教師一項重要的**個人特質**。」

Practice 11

> “The material has several unusual **qualities**.”

「這種材料具有幾項不尋常的**性質／特性**。」

a quality = 某人或某事物本身具有的一項特徵、性格或性質

Notice the countability difference:

Standard

> “The product is of high **quality**.”

quality = 品質, 通常不可數

Characteristic

> “Honesty is a good **quality**.”

a quality / qualities = 特質, 可數

This distinction is extremely important.

6. **personal qualities** (個人的性格／能力特質) — 個人素質; 品格

Practice 12

> “Leadership requires several important personal **qualities**.”

「領導工作需要具備幾項重要的**個人素質**。」

Practice 13

> “Her best **qualities** are patience and honesty.”

「她最好的**性格特質**是耐性和誠實。」

personal qualities = 構成一個人性格、品格或能力表現的重要特質

This belongs to sense #5 rather than being an unrelated meaning.

7. **quality of life** (生活整體狀況) — 生活質素

Meaning: The overall degree of comfort, health, happiness, safety, freedom, and satisfaction in someone’s life.

Practice 14

> “Good public transport can improve **quality of life**.”

「良好的公共交通可以改善**生活質素**。」

Practice 15

> “The treatment improved her **quality of life**.”

「這項治療改善了她的**整體生活質素**。」

****quality of life = 一個人在健康、舒適、安全、自由和生活滿足感方面的整體生活水準****

This does not simply mean how “luxurious” someone's life is.

8. ****quality time (與重要的人專心相處的時間) — 優質相處時間; 有意義的共處時間****

This is an important family extension.

****Meaning:**** Time spent giving someone your full attention in an enjoyable or meaningful way.

Practice 16

> “I want to spend more **quality time** with my family.”

「我想花更多**專心陪伴家人、有意義地相處的時間**。」

Practice 17

> “The weekend gave them some **quality time** together.”

「這個週末讓他們有一些**不受干擾、好好相處的時間**。」

****quality time = 與某人專心、有意義地相處, 而不是只在同一地方卻各自忙碌的時間****

This is ****not**** simply “high-quality clock time.” It is a fixed expression.

9. ****air/water/environmental quality (環境條件的良好程度) — 空氣／水／環境質素****

Practice 18

> “Traffic has affected the city's air **quality**.”

「交通問題影響了城市的**空氣質素**。」

Practice 19

> “The laboratory regularly tests water **quality**.”

「實驗室定期檢測**水質**。」

****quality = 某種環境條件在純淨、安全或適合使用方面所達到的標準****

Again, this belongs to the main ****standard**** sense.

10. ****quality control (生產／服務) — 品質控制; 質量控制****

****Meaning:**** The process of checking products or work to make sure they meet required standards.

Practice 20

> “Every unit goes through strict ****quality control****.”

「每件產品都會經過嚴格的****品質控制檢查****。」

Practice 21

> “The factory strengthened its ****quality control**** procedures.”

「工廠加強了****品質控制程序****。」

****quality control = 透過檢查、測試和糾正問題, 確保產品／成果符合既定品質標準的程序****

11. ****quality assurance (品質保證制度) — 品質保證; 品質管理****

This is related to, but not exactly the same as, quality control.

****Meaning:**** A systematic process designed to prevent quality problems and ensure that work consistently meets standards.

Practice 22

> “The company has a dedicated ****quality assurance**** team.”

「公司設有專門的**品質保證團隊**。」

Practice 23

> “Quality assurance begins before production starts.”

「**品質保證工作**在生產開始之前便已展開。」

****quality assurance = 建立制度和流程以預防品質問題, 確保整體工作持續符合標準****

Important distinction: **quality control vs quality assurance**

A useful simplified distinction:

**quality control (QC)**

focuses mainly on ****checking the output****

> Is this product defective?

= ****檢查產品結果有沒有問題****

**quality assurance (QA)**

focuses mainly on ****improving/preventing problems in the process****

> Is our process designed to consistently produce good products?

= ****建立可靠流程, 預防問題出現****

They overlap in real organizations, but the distinction is useful.

12. **qualitative = relating to qualities/characteristics rather than numerical amount — 質性的; 著重性質而非數量的**

This is an important academic family member.

****Meaning:**** Relating to the nature, characteristics, experiences, or descriptions of something rather than primarily to numerical measurement.

Practice 24

> “The researchers conducted **qualitative** interviews.”

「研究人員進行了**質性訪談**，以了解參與者的經驗和看法。」

Practice 25

> “The report includes both quantitative and **qualitative** data.”

「報告同時包含量化和**質性資料**。」

qualitative = 著重事物的性質、經驗、特徵或描述，而不是主要以數字衡量的

13. **qualitatively** = in terms of nature/character rather than quantity — 從性質上；質性地

Practice 26

> “The two experiences are **qualitatively** different.”

「這兩種經歷在**性質**上有根本不同。」

Practice 27

> “The second solution is not just faster; it is **qualitatively** better.”

「第二個方案不只是更快，它在**本質和品質層面**上也有所提升。」

qualitatively = 從事物的性質、種類或本質差異來看，而不是只比較數量

Important distinction: quality vs feature

This connects directly with your previous target.

feature

= what a product **has**

> “Noise cancellation is a feature.”

「降噪是一項功能。」

quality

= how good something **is**

> “Sound quality is excellent.”

「音質很好。」

So:

feature = 功能／特點

quality = 品質／水準

However, **sound quality itself can be listed as a product feature** because it is an important product characteristic.

Important distinction: **quality vs characteristic**

quality = standard

> “The quality is excellent.”

= 品質很高。

a quality = characteristic

> “Patience is a good quality.”

= 耐性是一項良好特質。

So the exact same word can mean either:

品質水準

or

特質／性質

depending on grammar and context.

Important distinction: **quality vs quantity**

A classic pair:

quality

= how good something is

quantity

= how much or how many there is

> “We should focus on quality, not quantity.”

「我們應重視**質素, 而不是數量**。」

This expression is extremely common.

Important distinction: **quality vs standard**

They overlap strongly.

quality

often means the actual level of excellence.

standard

can mean:

- * an expected level;
- * a rule/specification;
- * actual level of performance.

> “The product meets safety standards.”

「產品符合安全標準。」

> “The product is of high quality.”

「產品品質很高。」

Important distinction: **quality vs value**

quality

= how good the product itself is

value

= how worthwhile it is relative to what you pay/get

A product can be:

high quality but poor value

= **品質很好, 但價格太高, 不太物有所值**

or:

average quality but good value

= **品質普通, 但價格划算**

Important distinction: **quality vs condition**

quality

= inherent or overall standard

condition

= current physical state, especially whether used, damaged, worn, etc.

> “This is a high-quality chair in poor condition.”

「這是一張**品質很好但目前狀況很差**的椅子。」

So these are not the same.

Important countability note: **quality / qualities**

quality = standard

Usually uncountable:

> “The sound is of excellent **quality**.”

「聲音品質極佳。」

a quality / qualities = characteristic(s)

Countable:

> “Honesty is an important **quality**.”

「誠實是一項重要特質。」

> “She has many good **qualities**.”

「她有很多良好特質。」

This is one of the biggest grammar distinctions to remember.

Family-extension note

Following our Golden Manual, these are especially useful:

* **sound quality** = 音質

* **image quality** = 畫質

* **build quality** = 造工品質

* **air quality** = 空氣質素

* **water quality** = 水質

* **high-quality** = 高品質的

* **poor-quality** = 品質差的

* **quality product** = 優質產品

* **personal qualities** = 個人素質／性格特質

* **quality of life** = 生活質素

* **quality time** = 專心而有意義的相處時間

* **quality control** = 品質控制

* **quality assurance** = 品質保證

* **qualitative** = 質性的

* **qualitatively** = 從性質上／質性地

A very common expression also worth remembering:

> **quality over quantity**

= **重質不重量／品質比數量重要**

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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quality — standard	某項產品、服務或成果在「好與差」方面所達到的整體水準
sound/image/build quality	某一特定方面在清晰度、表現或製作等方面所達到的品質標準
high-/poor-quality	品質達到較高／較低標準的
quality + noun	品質優良、達到較高水準的
a quality — characteristic	某人或某事物本身具有的一項性格、特徵或性質
personal qualities	構成一個人的性格、品格或能力表現的重要特質
quality of life	一個人在健康、舒適、安全、自由和滿足感方面的整體生活水準
quality time	與重要的人專心、有意義且不受其他事情干擾地相處的時間
environmental quality	空氣、水或其他環境條件在純淨、安全和適用方面的水平
quality control	透過檢查和測試，確保最終產品／成果符合既定品質標準
quality assurance	透過制度和流程預防品質問題並持續確保符合標準
qualitative	著重事物的性質、特徵、經驗或描述，而非主要以數字衡量的
qualitatively	從事物的本質、性質或種類差異來看

For your original sentence

> “The ad mentioned practical features like comfort, battery life, and sound **quality**...”

The exact meaning is:

quality = 某項東西在好與差方面所達到的水準

and specifically:

sound quality = 耳機所播放的聲音在清晰度、細節、平衡、自然度和整體聽感方面的品質

So the natural Traditional Chinese is simply:

sound quality = 音質.